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The Scientific attitude, Critical thinking, and Developing Arguments

vocab

Psychology

The scientific study of behaviour & mental processes

Scientific Attitude

A mindset required for scientific inquiry

→ Curiosity

Desire to learn & ask 'Does it work?'

→ Skepticism

A critical Approach that questions assumptions

→ Humility

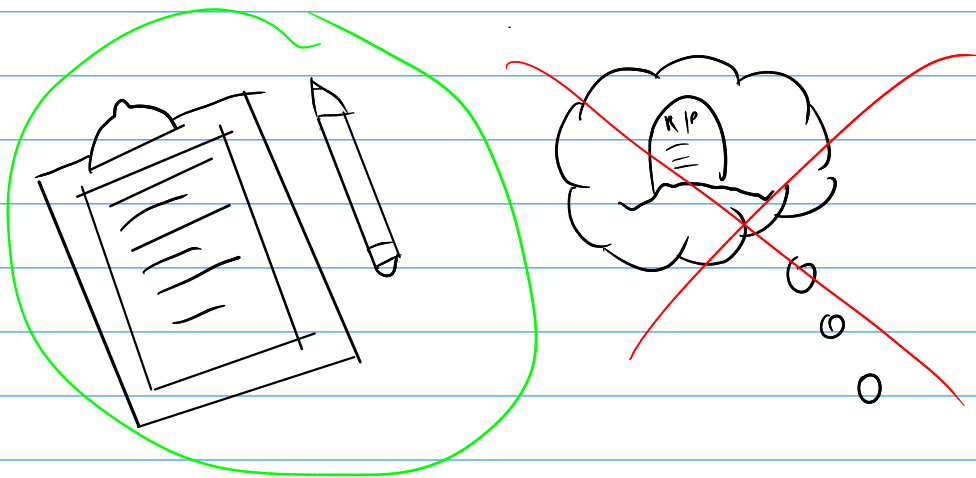
Awareness to one's own vulnerability to error

Critical Thinking

Examines assumptions, considering sources, bias, practice: doesn't take everything at face value

— How is Psychology a Science? —

- Certain idealistic questions cannot be answered by science, like questions about religion
- Other scientific questions may be answered using scientifically determined evidence
- For example, James Randi used an evidence based approach to answer if "seers" had the power to see auras as they claimed



— What is the Scientific Attitude —

- It does not matter how 'Obvious' or 'Outrageous' an Idea is. The only thing of worth is: "Does it work?"
- Science tends towards truth. Over years, pseudoscientific falsehoods are discarded, replaced with empirical ideas

- Individuals shouldn't seek to prove their own opinions but to advance our collective knowledge of the truth

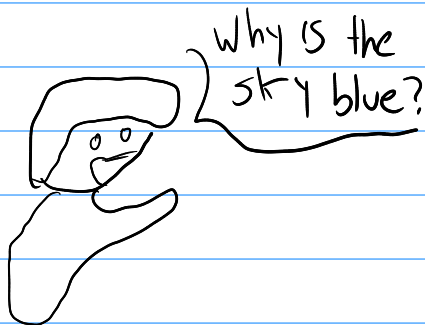
The Scientific Attitude

'Does it work?'

Curiosity

'Why?'
('Does it work?')

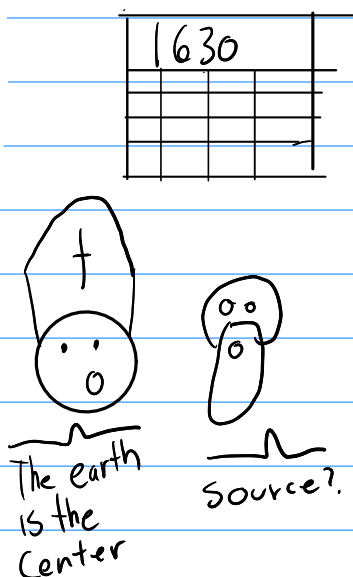
A genuine desire to learn and understand the world, advancing our collective knowledge



Skepticism

'How do you know?'

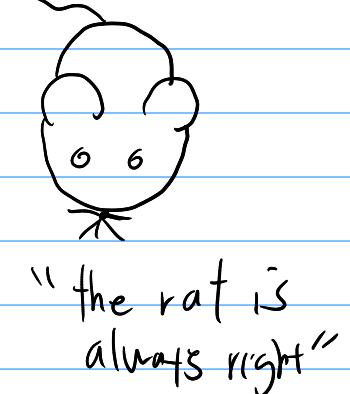
An optimal middle ground between harsh cynicism and gullibility



Humility

'I was wrong.'

A willingness to discard a false opinion in the pursuit of truth



How does Critical Thinking tie into The Scientific Attitude

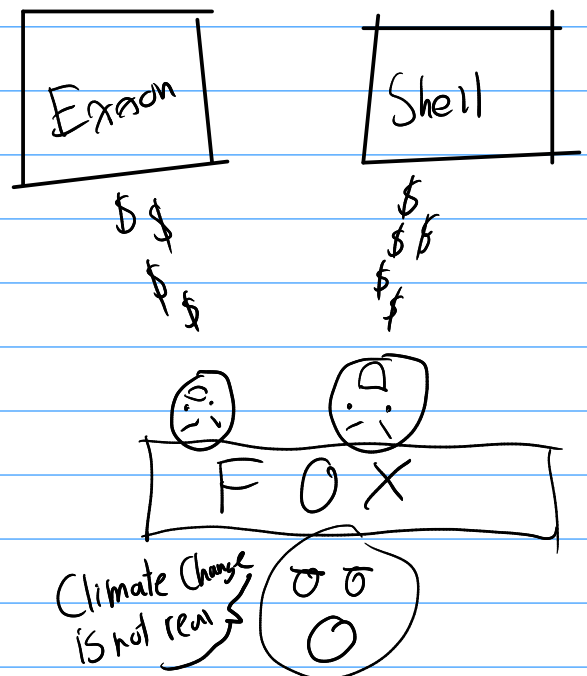
Critical thinking is an essential part of The Scientific attitude.

When consuming media ALWAYS ASK YOURSELF:

- How do they know this?
- What is this source's motive, bias & agenda
- Is the conclusion scientifically derived
- Does the evidence suggest a cause-effect
- Other explanations?

Personal Relation

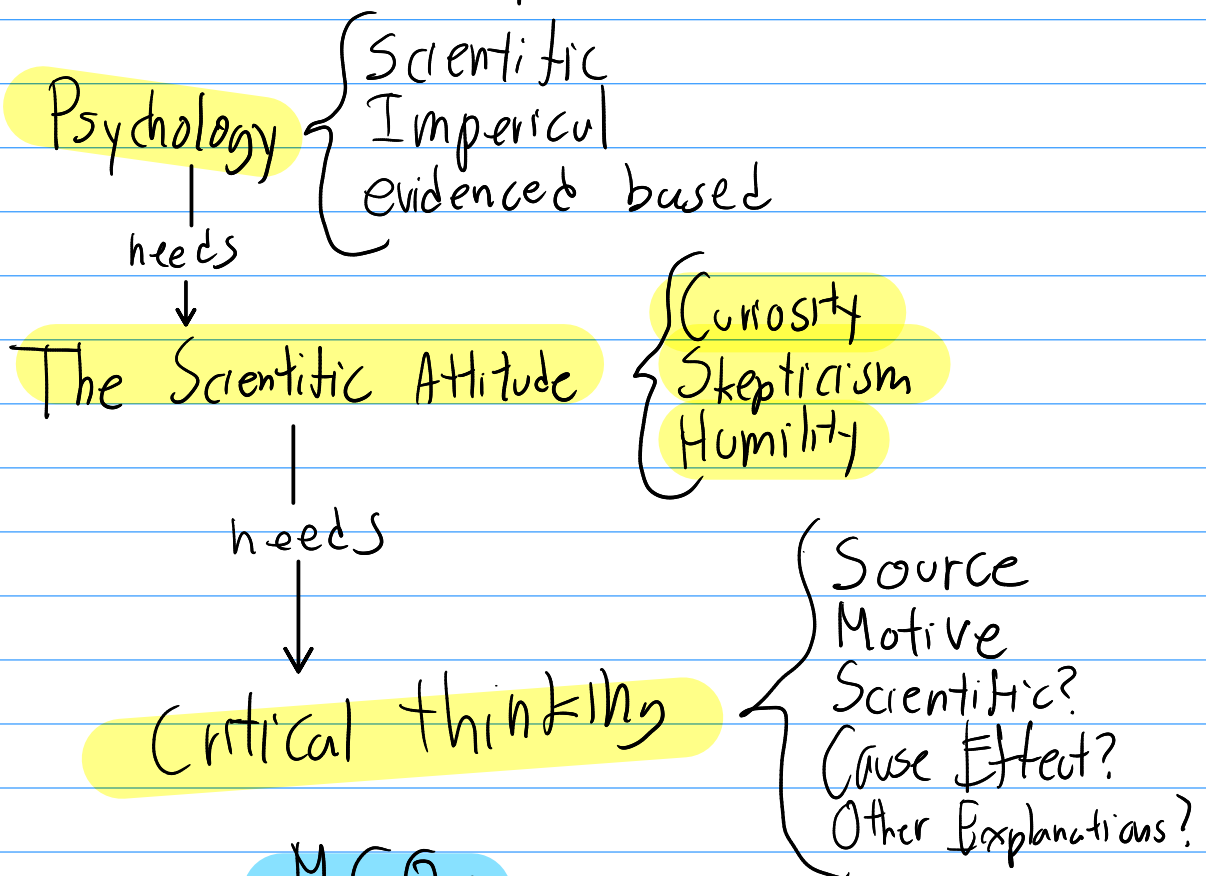
The other day, I saw several articles about the DPRK executing 30 officials. I asked 'How do they know that?' This led me to the only source they all cited: Chosun Ilbo. I then asked 'What is this source's Agenda?' I then found out that Chosun Ilbo is a far right South Korean outlet that has been shown to make false stories about the DPRK. So I was able to dismiss this story.



Critical thinking allows us to dismiss claims based on mere feelings.

Critical thinkers realize they may be wrong

Summary



MCQs

1. C 2. C 3. C 4. B 5. D 6. A